



Tokens, components and usage rules for the Nookly study planner: the marketing site and the app share one visual language.

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Nookly is a concept brand created for this exercise. Example content is placeholder.

Principles & voice

Students open Nookly when they're already stressed. Every decision in this system aims to make the next step feel small and clear.

1. **Calm over urgent.** Students open Nookly when they're already stressed. Paper-warm grounds, soft radii and plenty of space; no red overdue walls. `danger` is for real errors only.
2. **One loud thing.** Coral marks the single most important action in a view. Everything else is ink, cream and white. If two things are coral, one of them is wrong.
3. **Show the plan.** Prefer real UI (a task list, a timer, a grade target) over illustration. Numbers are set in Fraunces so they read as achievements, not data.
4. **Friendly, not childish.** Rounded pills and a bookish serif, but adult copy and no mascots or emoji.

Voice and content

- Talk like a helpful older student: short sentences, second person, plain words. "Missed Monday? We moved Chem reading to Thursday."
- Sentence case for every heading, button and label. The only uppercase text is the `eyebrow` style and the "NEW" badge.
- Buttons start with a verb and say what happens: "Start free", "Add course", "Save changes".
- Errors say what went wrong and how to fix it, without blame: "Use letters then numbers, like BIO201."
- Numbers: "45 min", "Due Fri", "₹199 / month", "68%". Use the middle dot (·) to join metadata: "Biology · 35 min".

Interaction and motion

- Hover: buttons darken 8% and lift 2px with `shadow-2`; cards with `href` lift 2px. 150ms ease-out.
- Focus: every interactive element shows a 3px `focus` ring with a 3px offset. Inputs use a 4px `lilac` halo instead.
- Touch targets are at least 44px. `sm` controls (40px) are desktop-only.
- Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`: no lifts, slow spinners.

Colour tokens

24 semantic tokens, each with a light and a dark value (left and right half of every chip). Components never use raw hex values, only these names.

 surface #FBF7F0 · #121826 Page background (Cream). The default ground for every screen.	 surface-raised #FFFFFF · #1B2335 Cards, inputs, menus and anything that sits on top of the page.	 surface-sunken #F3EDE3 · #0D121D Wells, disabled fields, the track behind progress bars.	 surface-inverse #172033 · #26304A Dark (Ink) blocks: the one differentiator card, stats bands, footers.
 ink #172033 · #F3EEEE6 Primary text and icons on surface and surface-raised (15:1 or better in both themes).	 ink-muted #5A6275 · #A9AFBD Body copy, hints, secondary labels (5.7:1 on surface).	 ink-subtle #8A8FA0 · #7C8497 Placeholder text and disabled labels only; never for text a person must read (3.2:1).	 on-inverse #FBF7F0 · #F3EEEE6 Text and icons on surface-inverse.
 line #E8E1D6 · #2C3549 Card borders, dividers and table rules. Decorative only.	 line-control #8C92A3 · #6D7690 Borders of inputs, checkboxes and radios: they must reach 3:1 against surface-raised.	 coral #FF6A45 · #FF7A58 Primary action fill ONLY. One coral element per view is the goal.	 coral-hover #F2562F · #FF8E70 Hover and pressed fill for coral buttons.
 on-coral #172033 · #172033 Text on coral. Ink, not white: white on coral fails AA (2.9:1); ink passes (5.7:1).	 coral-strong #AD3714 · #FF9477 Coral as TEXT: eyebrows, links, inline emphasis, coral badge text (5.9:1 on surface, 5.1:1 on coral-soft).	 coral-soft #FFE1D8 · #3A2320 Tinted backgrounds for coral badges and warning notes.	 sage #6FAF94 · #7CC0A3 Progress fills, completed checkboxes, success marks (non-text).
 sage-strong #2F6B53 · #8FD3B5 Success text and check icons on light grounds (6.2:1).	 sage-soft #DCEFE6 · #1C3229 Success badge and note backgrounds.	 lilac #C9C3FF · #C9C3FF Highlights: NEW badges, marker behind a headline word, focus halo on inputs.	 lilac-soft #EDEAFF · #29264A Selected rows, info notes, soft card tint.
 on-lilac #172033 · #172033 Text and icons on lilac, sage and coral fills in both themes (always dark ink).	 danger #B42318 · #FF8A80 Error text, error borders and error icons (6.6:1 on surface-raised).	 danger-soft #FDE7E4 · #3B1D1C Error note backgrounds.	 focus #172033 · #F3EEEE6 Focus ring colour for every interactive element: a 3px ring, 3px offset.

Colour roles & contrast

The palette is five brand colours plus neutrals, each with one job.

ROLE	TOKENS	RULE
Ground	surface, surface-raised, surface-sunken	Cream page, white cards, sunken wells. Alternate surface and surface-raised sections to separate bands without rules.
Text	ink, ink-muted, ink-subtle	Headings and labels in ink, body in ink-muted. ink-subtle is for placeholders and disabled text only.
Action	coral, coral-hover, on-coral	Primary buttons only. Text on coral is always ink (white fails contrast).
Coral as text	coral-strong, coral-soft	Eyebrows, links, "due soon" badges. Never use coral itself for text.
Progress	sage, sage-strong, sage-soft	Done, on track, progress fills.
Highlight	lilac, lilac-soft, on-lilac	NEW badges, headline highlight marker, input focus halo.
Emphasis block	surface-inverse, on-inverse	One dark card per row, stats bands, footer.
Error	danger, danger-soft	Validation and destructive confirmations.

Proportion: roughly 60% ground, 25% ink, 10% lines and white, 5% coral and accents.

Contrast: every text pairing listed in a token's usage note meets WCAG AA (4.5:1) in both themes; control borders (line-control) and focus rings meet 3:1. Colours that carry meaning (sage vs coral vs danger) also differ in lightness and are paired with icons or words.

Contrast of the pairings the components use

PAIRING	LIGHT	DARK	REQUIRED
ink on surface	15.2:1	15.4:1	4.5:1 (AA text)
ink-muted on surface	5.7:1	8.1:1	4.5:1 (AA text)
ink-subtle on surface-raised	3.2:1	4.2:1	3:1 (placeholder only)
on-coral on coral	5.7:1	6.3:1	4.5:1 (AA text)
coral-strong on surface	5.9:1	8.2:1	4.5:1 (AA text)
coral-strong on coral-soft	5.1:1	6.8:1	4.5:1 (AA text)
sage-strong on sage-soft	5.2:1	7.9:1	4.5:1 (AA text)
danger on surface-raised	6.6:1	6.9:1	4.5:1 (AA text)
on-inverse on surface-inverse	15.2:1	11.3:1	4.5:1 (AA text)
on-lilac on lilac	9.9:1	9.9:1	4.5:1 (AA text)
line-control on surface-raised	3.1:1	3.5:1	3:1 (non-text)
focus on surface	15.2:1	15.4:1	3:1 (non-text)

Typography

Two Google-hosted families:

- **Fraunces SemiBold (600)** — `display` family. Headlines, testimonials, and big numbers (prices, stats, timers).
A warm, bookish serif that signals "study" without feeling academic.
- **DM Sans (400 / 500 / 700)** — `sans` family. Everything else: UI, body, labels, buttons.

Rules: one `display-xl` per page; body text never below 16px; `caption` (12px) is the floor for any text; line length 55–75 characters; headings use `text-wrap: balance`. On mobile step headings down one level (`display-xl` → 40/44, `display-l` → `display-m`).

Type scale (desktop)

display-xl

64px / 68px · 600 ·
-0.02em

Plans you'll
follow

display-l

44px / 50px · 600 ·
-0.01em

Set up once. Follow all
term.

display-m

30px / 36px · 600

Priced for a student budget

quote

22px / 32px · 600

“Zero panic.”

title

22px / 28px · 700

Missed a day? It re-plans.

body-l

18px / 28px · 400

Drop in your course outline.

body

16px / 24px · 400

Nookly builds your week around your classes.

label

14px / 20px · 700

University email

small

14px / 20px · 400

Biology · 35 min · Due Fri

caption

12px / 16px · 500

Updated 2 min ago

eyebrow

13px / 16px · 700 · 0.12em

HOW IT WORKS

Spacing, radius, elevation

- **Grid:** desktop 1440 frame, 12 columns, 1200px container, 24px gutter, 120px side margin. Tablet 8 columns, 32px margin. Mobile 4 columns, 16px gutter, 20px margin.
- **Spacing** follows an 8-point scale (`space-1` ... `space-10`). Use `gap` on flex and grid containers instead of margins. Section padding is `space-10` (120) on desktop and `space-9` (72) on mobile; heading to content is `space-8` (64) / 28px.
- **Radius** grows with size: `radius-md` inputs → `radius-lg` cards → `radius-xl` feature bands. Buttons and badges are always `radius-pill`.
- **Elevation** is rare. Most cards are flat with a 1px `line` border; `shadow-2` is for things that float (pricing, testimonials, menus); `shadow-3` for the one hero product shot.

Spacing scale

space-1 · 4px		Icon-to-text in tight chips; hairline nudges.
space-2 · 8px		Gap inside buttons and badges; label to input.
space-3 · 12px		Gap between stacked form fields' hint and input; list rows.
space-4 · 16px		Mobile side gutter; gap between related fields.
space-5 · 24px		Grid gutter; mobile card padding; gap between cards.
space-6 · 32px		Desktop card padding (compact); gap between form groups.
space-7 · 40px		Desktop card padding (feature cards).
space-8 · 64px		Section heading to section content, desktop.
space-9 · 72px		Section padding, mobile.
space-10 · 120px		Section padding, desktop.

Radius

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
<code>radius-sm</code>	8px	 Checkboxes, small chips, bars inside charts.
<code>radius-md</code>	12px	 Inputs, selects, textareas, icon tiles.
<code>radius-lg</code>	20px	 Cards.
<code>radius-xl</code>	28px	 Full-width feature bands and CTA blocks.
<code>radius-pill</code>	999px	 Buttons, badges, switches, progress bars.

Elevation

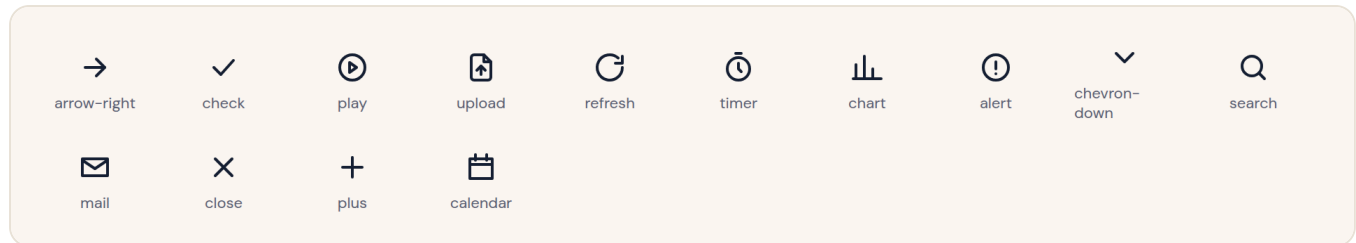
TOKEN	LIGHT VALUE	USE
<code>shadow-1</code>	0 1px 2px rgba(23,32,51,0.06)	 Resting controls on raised surfaces.
<code>shadow-2</code>	0 12px 32px rgba(23,32,51,0.08)	 Cards that float: testimonials, pricing, menus.
<code>shadow-3</code>	0 30px 60px rgba(23,32,51,0.25)	 Hero product shots and dialogs. At most one per view.

Control heights

`control-sm` 40px (dense desktop only) · `control-md` 48px (default) · `control-lg` 56px (hero and pricing CTAs; mobile primary 52px).

Icon

Variants / props: name, size (16 · 18 · 20 · 24), strokeWidth, label



A small set of line icons drawn on a 24px grid with a 2px round stroke, coloured by `currentColor`.

Sizes

16 (inside small buttons and badges), 18 (buttons), 20 (inputs, default), 24 (card icon tiles, standalone).

Guidelines

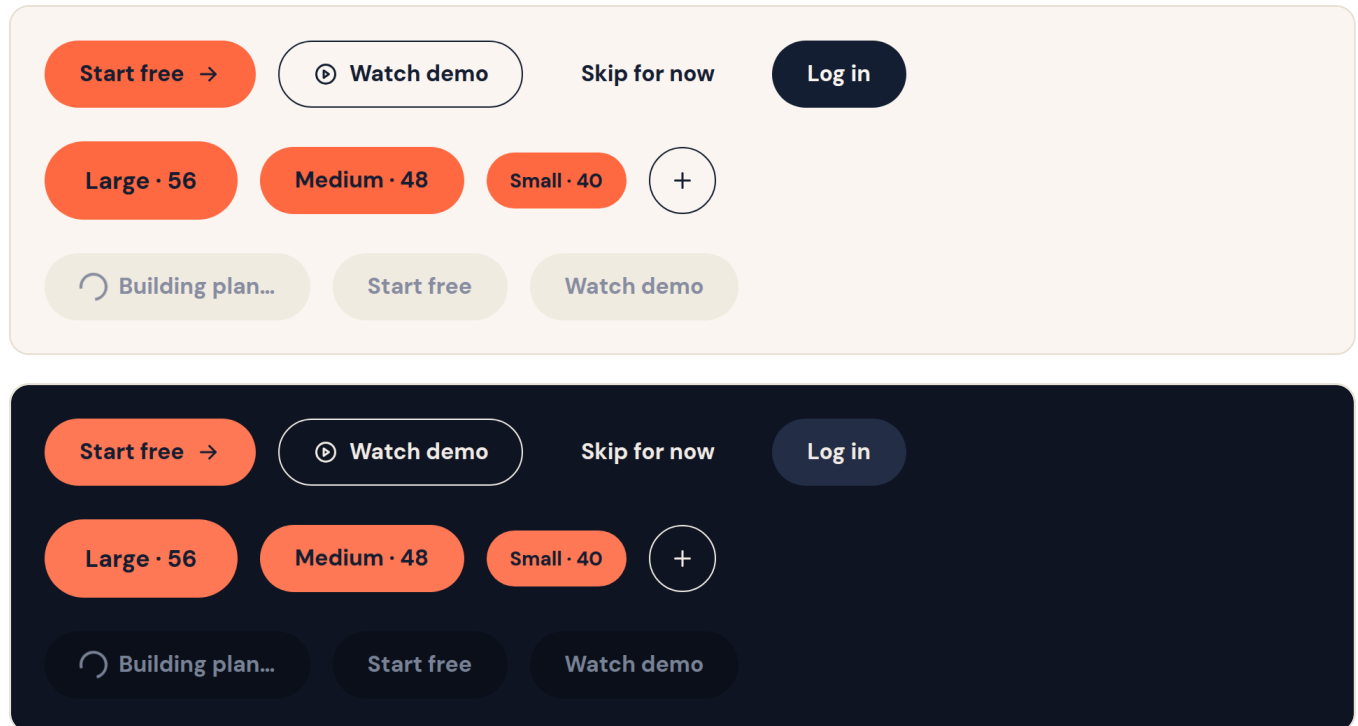
- Icons support a label; they never replace one, except in icon-only buttons with an `aria-label`.
- Decorative icons are hidden from screen readers automatically. Pass `label` only when the icon carries meaning alone.
- Keep the 2px stroke. For 14–16px use `strokeWidth` 2.4–2.6 so the icon doesn't look faint.
- Inside icon tiles the icon is always ink (`#172033`), whatever the tile colour.
- Need a new icon? Draw it on the same grid: 2px stroke, round caps and joins, 2px padding, no fills.

Available names

arrow-right, check, play, upload, refresh, timer, chart, alert, chevron-down, search, mail, close, plus, calendar.

Button

Variants / props: variant: primary | secondary | ghost | inverse · size: sm | md | lg · iconLeft · iconRight · iconOnly · loading · disabled · fullWidth · href (dark theme below)



A pill-shaped action that says exactly what happens when it is pressed.

Variants

VARIANT	LOOKS LIKE	USE FOR
primary	Coral fill, ink text	The one action the view exists for: "Start free", "Save plan". One per view.
secondary	Ink 1.5px outline	The alternative to primary: "Watch demo", "Cancel".
ghost	Text only, sunken fill on hover	Low-emphasis actions in toolbars and cards: "Skip for now".
inverse	Ink fill, cream text	Actions placed on coral or photographic grounds, and nav "Log in".

Sizes

lg 56px (hero and pricing CTAs), **md** 48px (default), **sm** 40px (dense desktop tables only; below the 44px touch target, so never on mobile). Mobile primary buttons are **fullWidth** at 52px.

States

Default → hover (8% darker fill, 2px lift, **shadow-2**, 150ms ease-out) → focus (3px **focus** ring, 3px offset) → loading (spinner replaces the left icon, label changes to the present tense: "Building plan...") → disabled (**surface-sunken** fill, **ink-subtle** text).

Writing the label

- Start with a verb, sentence case, 1–3 words: "Start free", "Add course", "Save changes".

- Say what happens, not "OK", "Submit" or "Click here".
- Arrow icon (`iconRight="arrow-right"`) only on forward-moving primary actions.

Do / Don't

- **Do** pair one primary with one secondary. **Don't** put two coral buttons side by side.
- **Do** give icon-only buttons an `aria-label`. **Don't** use icon-only buttons for primary actions.
- **Don't** use a button for navigation to another page; pass `href` so it renders a real link.

Consumer provides

`children` (the label), `onClick` or `href`, and `aria-label` when `iconOnly` is set.

Text field

Variants / props: label · hint · error · optional · size: sm | md | lg · iconLeft · multiline · rows · disabled (dark theme below)

The light theme form contains four text fields arranged in a 2x2 grid. Top-left: 'University email' label, input with 'you@university.edu', hint 'We'll send your plan here.' below. Top-right: 'Search courses' label, input with 'Q e.g. BIO201'. Bottom-left: 'Student ID' label, input with 'NK-40221', hint 'Set by your university.' below. Bottom-right: 'Notes for this course (optional)' label, multiline text area with placeholder 'Anything Nookly should know? Lab weeks, reading-heavy weeks...'. To the right of the 'Course code' label is a red error message: 'ⓘ Use letters then numbers, like BIO201.'

The dark theme form is identical in layout and content to the light theme version, but with a dark background and lighter text colors for labels and hints. The error message remains red.

A labelled single-line input or multi-line textarea with an optional hint and an error message.

Anatomy

Label (`label` style, always visible) → control (48px, `radius-md`, 1.5px `line-control` border on `surface-raised`) → hint or error (14px). The error replaces the hint; they never show together.

Variants and states

- **Sizes:** `sm` 40px (desktop filters), `md` 48px (default), `lg` 56px (single-field sign-up forms).
- **With icon:** `iconLeft` for search and email fields only; the icon is decorative.
- **Multiline:** `multiline` renders a textarea, min 112px, vertically resizable.
- **States:** default → hover (`ink-muted` border) → focus (`focus` border + 4px `lilac` halo) → error (`danger` border, `danger-soft` halo on focus, alert icon + message) → disabled (`surface-sunken`, `ink-subtle`).

Guidelines

- The label is never replaced by the placeholder. Placeholders show an example ("e.g. BIO201"), not instructions.
- Mark the few optional fields with `optional`; don't asterisk the required ones.
- Validate on blur, not on every keystroke. Error text says what is wrong and how to fix it: "Use letters then numbers, like BIO201." Never "Invalid input".

- Use the right `type` (`email`, `tel`, `number`) so phones show the right keyboard.
- Stack fields in one column with `space-5` between them. Two columns only for short pairs on desktop (first and last name).

Consumer provides

`label` (required), `id` if you need a stable one, `value / onChange` or `defaultValue`, and the `error` string from your validation.

Select

Variants / props: label · options · placeholder · hint · error · optional · disabled

The image shows a form with three select components. The first is labeled 'Year of study' with a placeholder 'Choose your year'. The second is labeled 'Study reminders' with a placeholder 'Evenings, 6 pm'. The third is labeled 'Semester' with a placeholder 'Choose a semester'. The 'Semester' component is highlighted with a red border and a red error message: 'Choose a semester so we can place your deadlines.'

A native dropdown in the same field shell as TextField, for picking one option from a list of five or more.

When to use

- **5 or more options** → Select. **2–4 options** → RadioGroup, so every choice is visible. **On/off** → Switch or Checkbox.
- It is a native `<select>`, so phones open their own picker and keyboard support comes for free.

Anatomy and states

Same label, hint, error, sizes and states as TextField. A 20px `chevron-down` icon sits 16px from the right edge; the control reserves 44px of right padding so long labels never run under it.

Guidelines

- Use `placeholder` ("Choose your year") when there is no sensible default. Otherwise preselect the most common option.
- Order options logically (chronological, by size) or alphabetically; never randomly.
- Keep option labels short enough to fit the field width without truncation.

Consumer provides

`label`, `options` (strings or `{value, label, disabled}`), and `value / onChange` or `defaultValue`.

Checkbox & radio group

Variants / props: Checkbox: label · description · checked · disabled — RadioGroup: label · options[{{value,label,description,disabled}}] · value · onChange

- ☒ Read Ch. 4 — Cell signalling
Biology · 35 min
- ☐ Essay outline — Week 6
Writing · 45 min · Due Fri
- ☐ Lab report (locked until Week 6)

How long are your study sessions?

- ☒ 25 minutes
Short focus blocks with 5-minute breaks
- ☐ 50 minutes
Longer blocks with 10-minute breaks
- ☐ Custom length
Available on Pro

A single on/off choice, used for task completion and for multi-select options that take effect on submit.

Anatomy

24px box (`radius-sm`, 1.5px `line-control` border) + label (16/24) + optional description (14/20, `ink-muted`), `space-3` apart. The whole row is the click target.

States

Unchecked → checked (`sage` fill, ink tick) → focus (3px `focus` ring) → disabled (`surface-sunken`, `ink-subtle` label).

Guidelines

- Sage means "done" throughout Nookly, so a checked box reads as a completed task. Don't recolour it.
- Label the positive state: "Email me my weekly plan", not "Don't email me".
- In a list, stack checkboxes with `space-3` (compact) or `space-5` (with descriptions).
- A setting that applies immediately is a **Switch**, not a checkbox.

Consumer provides

`label`, `checked / onChange` or `defaultChecked`, optional `description`.

Radio group

A set of 2–5 mutually exclusive options, all visible at once, inside a labelled fieldset.

Anatomy

Legend (`label` style) → options stacked with `space-3`. Each option: 24px circle (1.5px `line-control` border), label, optional description.

States

Unselected → selected (ink fill with a 5px `surface-raised` inner ring) → focus (3px `focus` ring; arrow keys move the selection) → disabled.

Guidelines

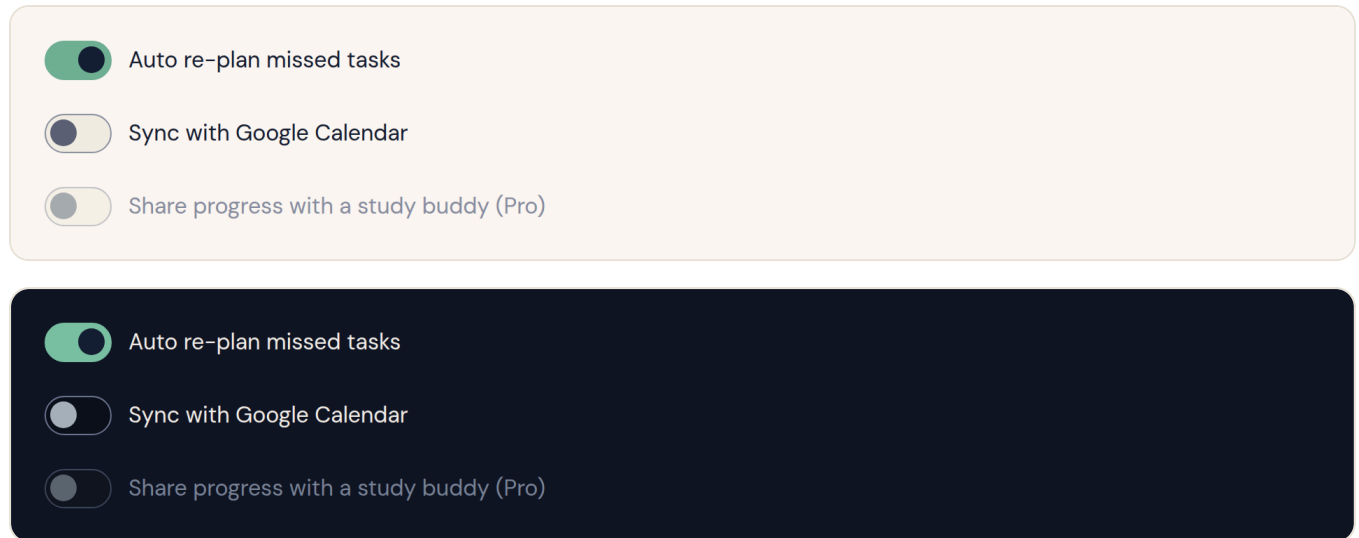
- Always preselect a sensible default unless choosing is the point of the question.
- More than five options → Select.
- Put the reason next to a disabled option ("Available on Pro") so it doesn't look broken.
- Stack vertically. Horizontal radios only for 2–3 very short labels (Yes / No).

Consumer provides

`options ({value, label, description?, disabled?})`, `label` for the legend, and `value / onChange` or `defaultValue`.

Switch

Variants / props: label · checked · defaultChecked · disabled · onChange (dark theme below)



A toggle for a setting that takes effect the moment it is flipped, with no Save button.

Anatomy

48 × 28px track (`radius-pill`) with a 19px thumb, followed by the label. Built as `<button role="switch" aria-checked>`.

States

Off (`surface-sunken` track, `ink-muted` thumb) → on (`sage` track, ink thumb slides right, 150ms) → focus (3px `focus` ring) → disabled (50% opacity).

Guidelines

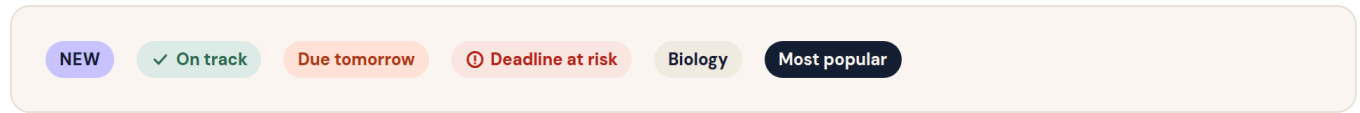
- Use only when the change applies immediately. If the user must press Save, use a Checkbox.
- The label names the setting, not the action: "Auto re-plan missed tasks", not "Turn on auto re-plan".
- Put the switch before its label on mobile so it lines up in lists of settings.

Consumer provides

`label`, `checked` / `onChange` or `defaultChecked`.

Badge

Variants / props: tone: neutral | coral | sage | lilac | danger | inverse · icon



A short, non-interactive label for status, category or promotion.

Tones

TONE	MEANS	EXAMPLE
sage	Good, done, on track	"On track"
coral	Needs attention soon	"Due tomorrow"
danger	Something is wrong	"Deadline at risk"
lilac	New or promoted	"NEW"
neutral	Category, no judgement	"Biology"
inverse	Highlight on light cards	"Most popular"

Guidelines

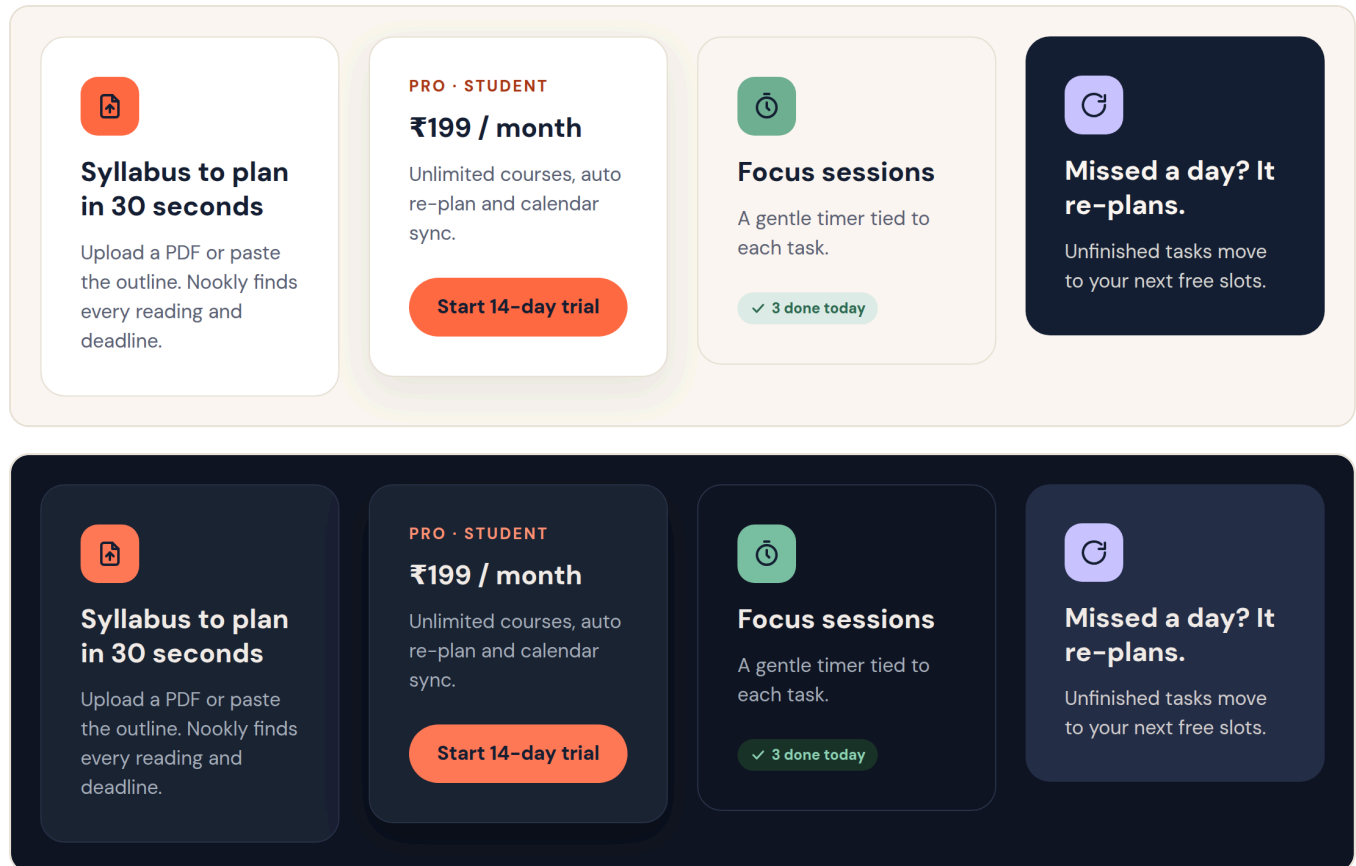
- 1–3 words. Sentence case, except **lilac** "NEW", which is uppercase with 4% tracking.
- Status badges (**sage** , **coral** , **danger**) can carry an icon so the meaning doesn't rely on colour alone.
- Badges are never buttons. If it can be clicked, use a ghost Button or a filter chip.
- One badge per card corner; don't stack badges.

Consumer provides

children (the text), **tone**, optional **icon**.

Card

Variants / props: variant: outlined | elevated | tinted | inverse · padding: sm | md | lg · icon · iconTone · eyebrow · title · footer · href (dark theme below)



A container for one self-contained idea: a feature, a plan, a review or a task summary.

Variants

VARIANT	SURFACE	USE FOR
outlined	surface-raised + 1px line	Default. Feature grids, settings groups.
elevated	outlined + shadow-2	Things that should feel picked up: pricing, testimonials, menus.
tinted	surface + 1px line	Cards placed on a white (surface-raised) section, so they still separate.
inverse	surface-inverse (Ink)	The one differentiator in a group, e.g. the "Pro" plan or "Auto re-plan" feature. At most one per row.

Anatomy

Optional icon tile (48px, 14px radius, coral / sage / lilac / neutral fill, ink icon) → optional eyebrow (eyebrow style in coral-strong) → title (title style) → body (body, ink-muted) → optional footer (pushed to the bottom, space-3 above). Padding: sm 24, md 32 (default), lg 40. Radius radius-lg.

Guidelines

- One idea per card, one primary action at most. Keep body copy to about 25 words.
- Cards in a row share variant, padding and height; let the grid stretch them, and put footers at the bottom so buttons line up.
- Use `href` to make the whole card a link (hover lifts 2px). Then don't nest other links or buttons inside.
- Don't nest cards inside cards. Don't add a coloured side border; use `inverse` or an icon tile for emphasis.
- On mobile, cards stack one per row with `space-4` gap and `sm` padding.

Consumer provides

`title`, `children` (a string becomes the body paragraph), and optionally `icon`, `iconTone`, `eyebrow`, `footer`, `href`, `headingLevel` to fit the page outline.

Using the system in Figma and code

Figma

1. Install the free **Tokens Studio for Figma** plugin, open it, and choose **Load from file** → `nookly-tokens.figma-tokens-studio.json`. You get three sets (core, light, dark) and two themes (Light, Dark).
2. Use **Styles & Variables** → **Export to Figma** in the plugin to create Figma variables for colour, spacing, radius and sizing, plus text styles for the 11 type styles.
3. Build each component as a Figma component set whose variant properties match the props above (for Button: `variant` × `size` × `state` = 4 × 3 × 5). Bind every fill, stroke, radius and padding to a variable, never a raw value.
4. Use the component screenshots in this guide as the visual reference for each state.

Native .fig files can't be generated outside Figma. The token file plus these specs contain everything needed to rebuild the library exactly, and the live design-system page is the source of truth for values.

Code

The live system ships a React bundle (`window.Nookly`), a stylesheet built only from token variables, and TypeScript definitions. Load `tokens.css` → `bundle.css` → React 18 → `bundle.js`, then use components by name:

```
<Nookly.Button variant="primary" iconRight="arrow-right">Start free</Nookly.Button>
```

Changing the system

- Add or change a token in the design system first, then update Figma variables from the token file, then code. Never hard-code a new colour in a screen.
- A new component needs a README (anatomy, states, do/don't, what the consumer provides) and a preview showing every variant before it is used in product.
- Any colour change re-runs the contrast table in section 2.